custom drifted into as far a past that only legends remain.

About the Author:



Matsuo Basho (1644-1694) is one of the most famous poets of Japan. In Japan, many of his poems are seen on monuments and traditional sites. Basho was introduced to poetry at a young age, and he quickly became well known throughout Japan. He made a living as a teacher but later travelled throughout the country to gain inspiration for his writing.

Glossary

despotic (adj.) – tyrannical, cruel

proclamation (n) – announcement

barbarous (adj.) – extremely brutal or mercilessly harsh

abandon (v) – desert, give up completely

reverence (n) – deep respect

mandate (n) – an official order

summit (n) – the topmost point of a hill or mountain

injunction (n) – an order restraining someone from performing an act

shriveled (adj.) – wrinkled and contracted due to old age or due to strain

gravely (adv.) – seriously

A. Rearrange the sentences given below in the correct sequence.

GMQUGT

1. The son made up his mind to take back his mother home.
2. A farmer decided to leave his old mother on top of a mountain.
3. The governor realized his mistake and abolished the law.
4. Once in Shining, a cruel ruler declared that all old people must be put to death.
5. Using the clever idea of his mother, the farmer made a rope of ashes.
6. When the farmer bade farewell, she advised him to return home with the aid of twigs.
7. Filled with dread, he hid his mother in his home.
8. The mother dropped the small twigs as markers on the way to help her son return.

B. Answer the following questions in one or two sentences.

1. What was the cruel announcement made by the leader?
2. Why was the farmer filled with sorrow?
3. What were the things carried by the farmer to the summit of the mountain?
4. Why did the mother become anxious as they climbed up the mountain?
5. What did the mother drop along the way?

10th English_Book.indb 122 26-02-2019 16:24:39